



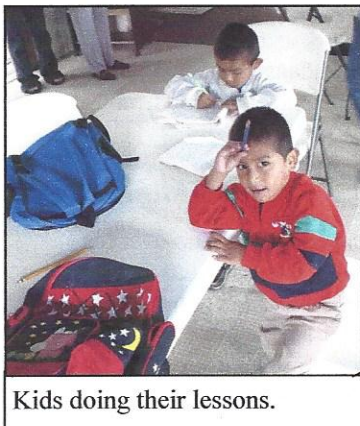
Saracoff Sentinel / Team Tijuana Jan. 2004

With our change to the Latin America Mission, the new year has been one of great promise. We are still doing the same things as we were doing before with the Home for the Elderly (Pastor Jesus or "Chuy" Mondragon), with Esperanza and the drug rehabilitation (Pastor Javier Marquez) and with the Hospice (Pastor Javier Rodríguez). The new addition to the group is Pastor Miguel and his wife Guille who run a ministry called "La Roca." Those who have followed our ministry will know that Miguel is not really new but a returning member of the group. Some of our old newsletters report working with teams in the early 90's to build what is now their elementary school.



He was one of the first members of our "Shekinah" pastoral prayer group. Pastor Miguel has been running this school for 12 years. Children who can't get into the public schools are welcome here—those without paperwork, birth certificates, transcripts or who are too old for their grade level. La Roca has a special program approved by the government in which they can be accepted without birth certificates. He has over 110 children in his school, including 22 in kindergarten. The school has a library and computer lab with 10 computers. Napoleon will be working part-time in the library, helping with homework and teaching. basic computer. In addition to the school, La Roca is the unique home to six families.

In most orphanages in Tijuana, the majority of the children have at least one parent—their mother. What happens is that the father and provider of the family dies or abandons the family and the mother, with many children to provide for, has to go to work and cannot handle the situation. What makes La Roca special is that when the mothers come to enroll their children in the home, they are told their kids are welcome if the mother comes, too. La Roca ministers to the family as a unit. This system keeps mothers from dropping off their children and forgetting about them. The six families include 15 boys and 9 girls. They live in a large room sectioned off by sheets for each family. Pastor Miguel wants to build real walls with doors and upgrade the beds and furniture. Maybe you or your church would like to help with this project!



Kids doing their lessons.



Two of the families at La Roca.

Please send contributions to:
Latin America Mission
PO Box 527900
Miami, FL 33152-7900

Call Greg & Kathy (619) 420-7270

Contact information:
Write us at: 173 Whitney Street
Chula Vista, CA 91910
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Overview of our Pastoral Tijuana Team for 2004

Pastor Javier Marquez, wife Lydia and children, with Esperanza Drug Rehabilitation



Esperanza has a rehabilitation center of 100 men in Tijuana, plus a rescue mission downtown in the red-light district. He has other centers in different parts of Mexico which he oversees. His wife Lydia and daughter love to work with children. A center for 20 women is soon to open at Esperanza.

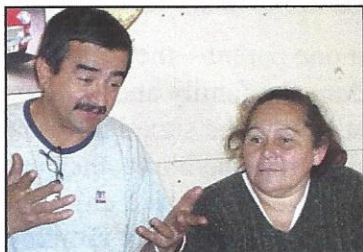
Pastor Jesus Mondragon with the home for the elderly. Jesus pastors three churches and his wife, **Magdalena** is pastor of a fourth. Volunteers from these churches help run the home for the elderly. Just as there are street kids, there are also street elderly—men and women over 65 without family, living on the streets, who need help. to live in dignity. **Casa Hogar** is a home for both elderly men and women.



This ministry started in the home of Pastor Jesus ("Chuy"). God moved his heart when he saw an elderly man eating out of a garbage can and brought him home. Then followed the next five and Magdalena found herself with a growing family. Thus with God's blessing and land given them by the community, the vision was born for Casa Hogar, the refuge for the elderly. The refuge has grown rapidly and in the last six months gone from near 30 to over 60 elderly.

Pastor Chuy has now started a project to build a new addition just for women as soon as funds become available.

Pastor Javier Rodriguez and wife Flor, a hospice center for the dying, sick, and injured.



Javier was a hardened criminal who was trapped by the self-gratification of drugs. After prison he met the Savior. Now his plans have changed and he spends his days rescuing the sick, wounded, and dying from the streets of Tijuana. Since there are no safety net social programs in Tijuana, when a man without a family breaks his back, or becomes severely ill, there is no one to help him. Then there are the street wounded (bullet and knife wounds) as well as those dying of Aids and tuberculosis. Javier and Flor take them all in at **El Campo de Fe**. They have a separate room for the

Pastor Miguel Villeneuve, wife Guille, and family at La Roca, a unique home and a free school.



La Roca provides a free school for poor children who are barred for lack of a birth certificate or who need remedial help. La Roca is also a home for children whose mothers must accompany them so the family can be helped as a whole. Pastor Miguel and his wife work as a team along with their four children (two not pictured). Their oldest daughter, Sinai, is the director of the school. **La Roca** includes a church and a free medical clinic for the community.

Greg and Kathy Saracoff with Ian and Anna. Missionaries in Tijuana with the Latin America Mission.



Greg began the Shekinah prayer meeting for the pastors' group over ten years ago in their home in Mexico. From this start the group has grown. They have learned how to network between ministries. There has been leadership training and Greg helps the pastors be accountable to leading a balanced life—taking one day a week off for rest, spending time with their wives, seeing beyond their own work to the group's goals. The Saracoffs connect churches and donors with the above pastors and their needs. They work with short-term teams on projects and outreach.

In addition to being a wife and mom, Kathy visits needy families and encourages moms in praying for their kids. She also edits the newsletters and organizes volunteers who come to help the different ministries.